during execution). The properties and methods of a class are collectively referred to as *members*. Member properties and functions typically require that an instance of the class (an object) are created before they can be accessed, so let's do that.

New Objects

```
$obj = new stdClass();
var_dump($obj);
```

```
Output:
object(stdClass)#1 (0) {
}
```

The keyword `new` combined with the classname `stdClass` and parentheses is an expression that tells PHP to make a new instance of `stdClass`, and we assign it to the variable `$obj`. PHP 8.4 allows you to omit the parentheses if they are empty, otherwise you can use them to pass argument data to the new object like a function call. The output of `var_dump()` isn't tremendously exciting because, well, `stdClass` is pretty boring.

`stdClass` is PHP's "generic, empty class" and intended to be a blank canvas. It is often seen when other data types are cast to objects, for example:

```
$beer = (object) ['Adnams', 'Bass'];
var_dump($beer);
```

```
Output:
object(stdClass)#1 (2) {
  ["0"]=>
  string(6) "Adnams"
  ["1"]=>
  string(4) "Bass"
}
```

`stdClass` also makes an appearance as the return of some PHP built-in functions:

```
var_dump(
    json_decode('{"beverage":"White Russian"}')
);
```